HintCode

Installation Guide

Get set up in under 2 minutes

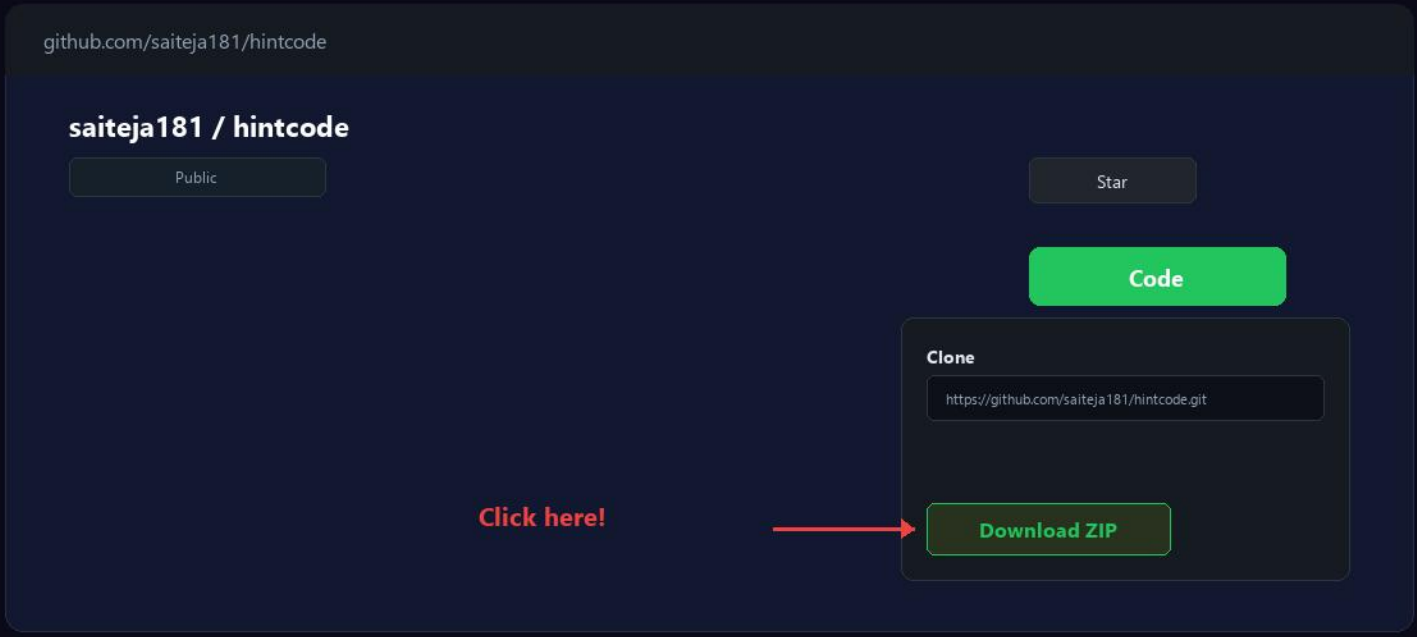
1. Download the extension
2. Open Chrome Extensions page
3. Enable Developer Mode
4. Load the extension
5. Get your free API key
6. Configure & test
7. Start getting hints!

Next: Step-by-step with screenshots

↓

github.com/saiteja181/hintcode

1 Download the Extension



Option A: Download ZIP

1. Click the green "Code" button on the repo page
2. Click "Download ZIP"
3. Extract the ZIP to any folder on your computer

Option B: Git Clone

```
git clone https://github.com/saiteja181/hintcode.git
```

2 Open Chrome Extensions

chrome://extensions/ → Type this in the address bar

3 Extensions

Turn ON → Developer mode

After enabling Developer mode, 3 buttons appear:

4 → **Load unpacked** | Pack extension | Update

Click "Load unpacked"

Select the folder where you extracted/cloned HintCode

Select Folder

C:\Users\you\Downloads\

Documents

Downloads

Select this!

5 Get Your Free API Key

HintCode uses Groq AI (completely free, no credit card needed)

A. Go to console.groq.com/keys

console.groq.com/keys

API Keys

Create and manage your API keys

Create API Key → Click this!

gsk_abc123xyz456...your_key_here Copy → Copy it!

B. Open HintCode Settings

Click HintCode icon in Chrome toolbar > Settings

HintCode Settings

PROVIDER

Groq (Free, no card needed)

API KEY

gsk_abc123xyz456... → Paste your key here

1 → Save Key Test Connection ← 2

Connection successful! AI is ready.

You are all set!

Go to any LeetCode problem and click "Stuck? Get a Hint"

7 Start Getting Hints!

Navigate to any coding problem on a supported platform

leetcode.com/problems/maximum-subarray/

53. Maximum Subarray

Medium

Given an integer array nums, find the subarray with the largest sum, and return its sum.

```
class Solution {
public:
    int maxSubArray(vector<int>& nums) {
        int m = 0, ans = 0;
        for (auto i : nums) {
            m += i;
            if (m < 0) m = 0;
            ans = max(ans, m);
        }
        return ans;
    }
};
```

Click this button!

(appears automatically)

Stuck? Get a Hint

The side panel opens with your hints:

Hint 1
Gentle Nudge

"Your line 4 initializes ans to 0. What if all numbers are negative?"

Hint 2
Approach

"Use Kadane's algorithm. Track max ending here vs global max."

Hint 3
Detailed

"Line 7 resets m to 0. Instead, take max(current element, sum + current)."

Each hint gets more specific.

Try to solve it yourself before moving to the next level!

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